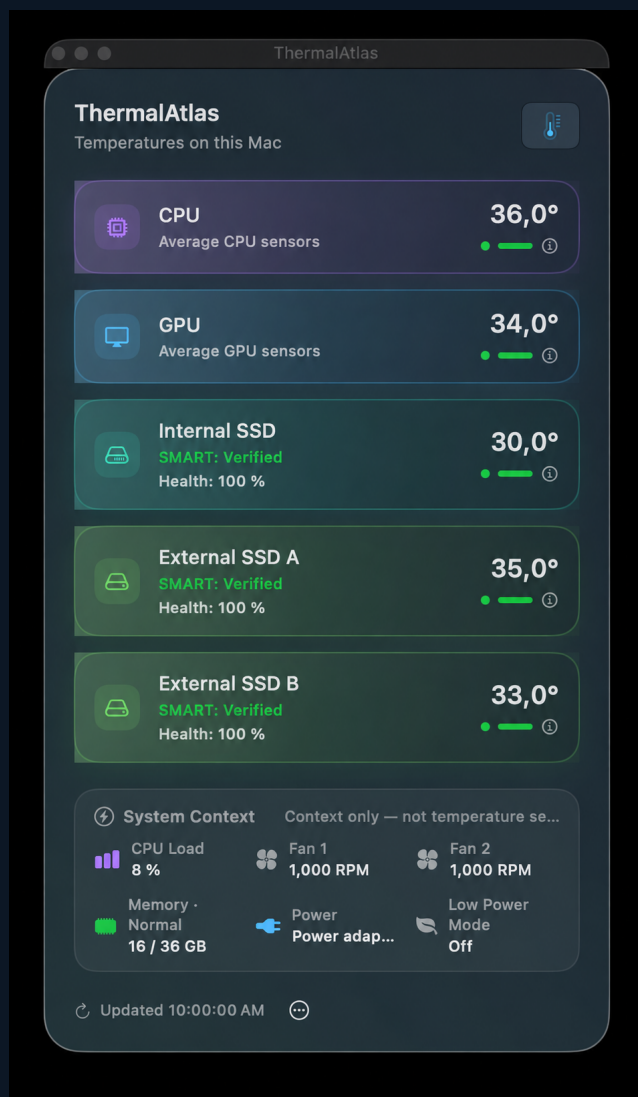


ThermalAtlas

Temperatures directly in the macOS menu bar

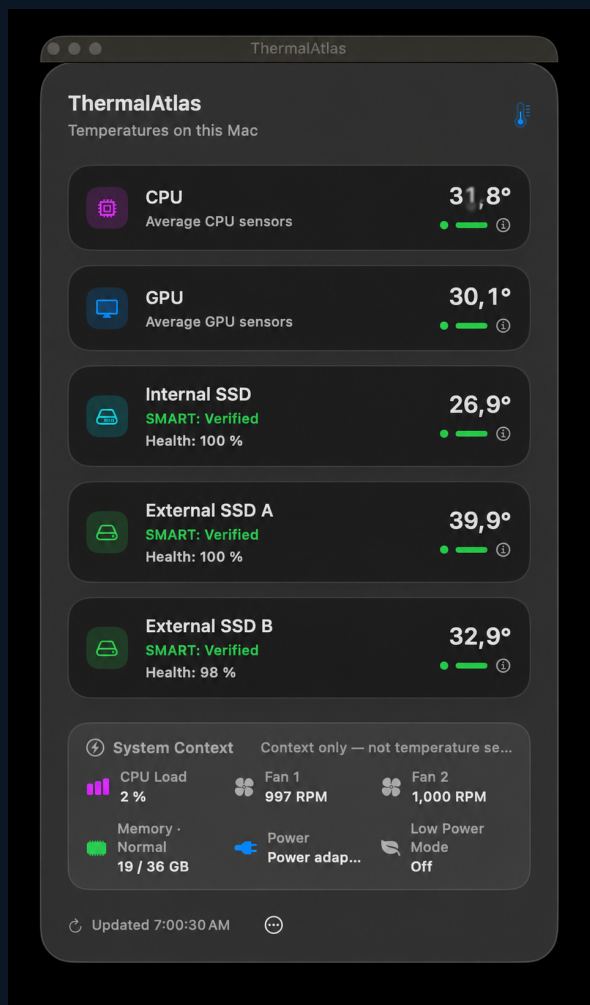


CPU · GPU · SSD

Real, locally read temperatures for Apple-silicon Macs.

Readings at a glance

Real values, clear context.



System Context

Context only — not temperature se...



CPU / GPU

Average of matching sensors that are readable right now.

SSD / SMART

Temperature, SMART status and health appear only when macOS supplies real data. External enclosures must pass SMART through; missing temperatures show Not available.

System Context

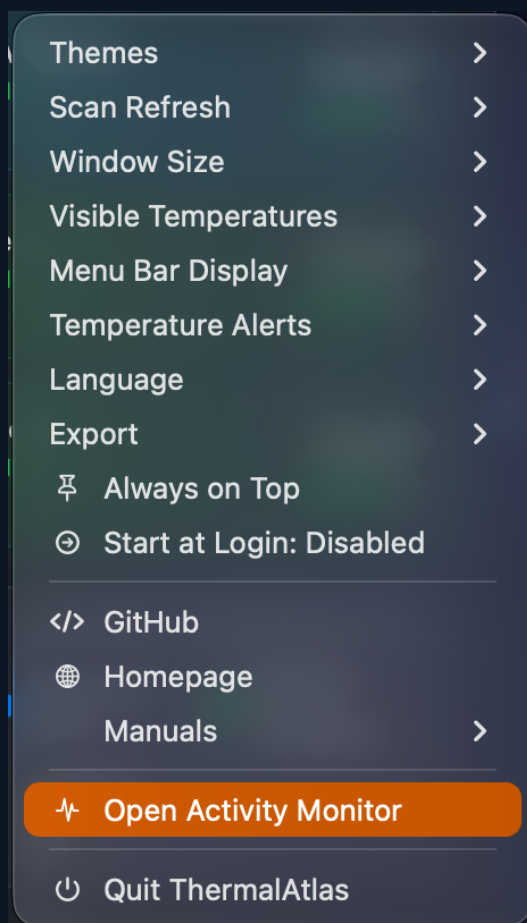
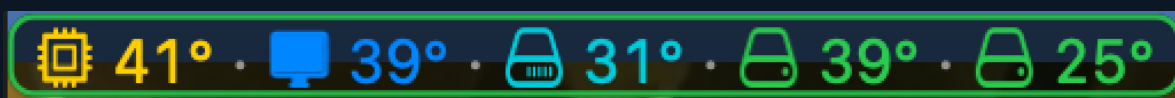
CPU load, Fan 1 and 2 in RPM, memory, power source and Low Power Mode. GPU load is not shown. Context values refresh about every 0.5 seconds.

Menu bar & controls

Every important setting in one shared footer menu.

Menu bar display

Colour-coded sensor symbols show every available value from the selected groups in a high-contrast status frame.



Themes / Scan Refresh

Appearance and refresh interval change only the interface or the frequency of read-only checks.

Export / Fenster

Below Export are Always on Top and Start at Login. Always on Top keeps the window visible above other apps.

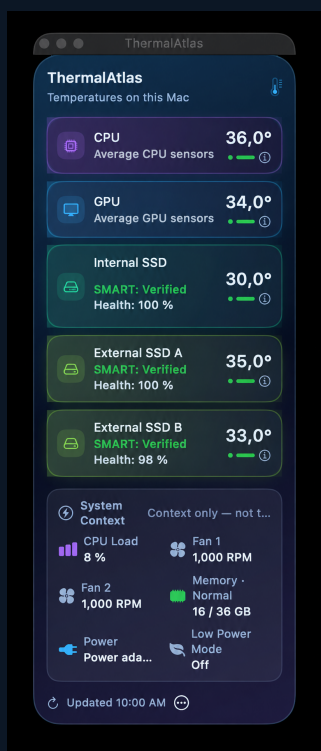
Window size & visible values

Both settings take effect immediately and are stored locally.

- ✓ Standard
- ⇄ Compact (about 40% smaller)
- ✓ Mini Display

Window Size

Standard keeps the generous card layout. Compact is about 40% narrower and uses denser cards, smaller spacing and smaller type. Mini Display replaces the window with a movable strip showing the selected temperatures. See page 5 for details.



Compact & history

The compact view retains the 1-, 3-, 6-, 12- and 24-hour temperature history.

- ✓ All Values
- 🔧 Symbol Only

Menu bar mode and visible temperature groups are also stored locally.

Compact floating display

Selected values stay visible without opening the large window.

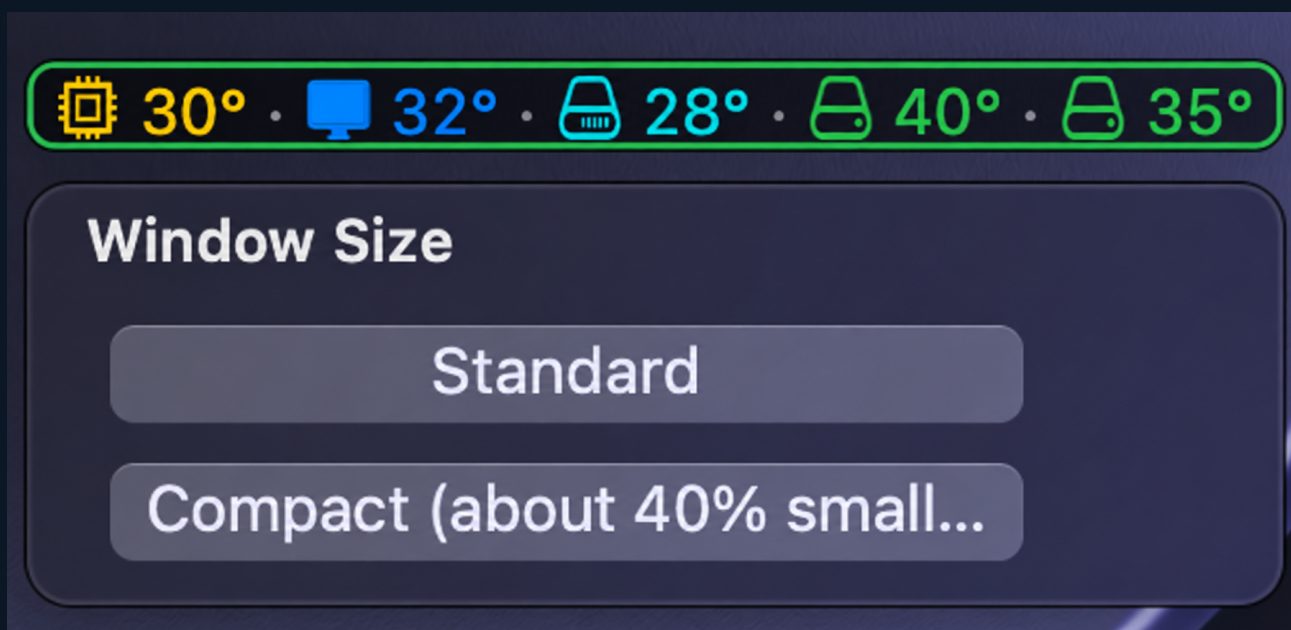
Mini Display

This choice replaces the large window with a narrow, movable strip showing the selected readable temperatures. Enable Always on Top to let it join other apps' full-screen spaces. Its behavior over a particular full-screen game still needs to be checked in that game.



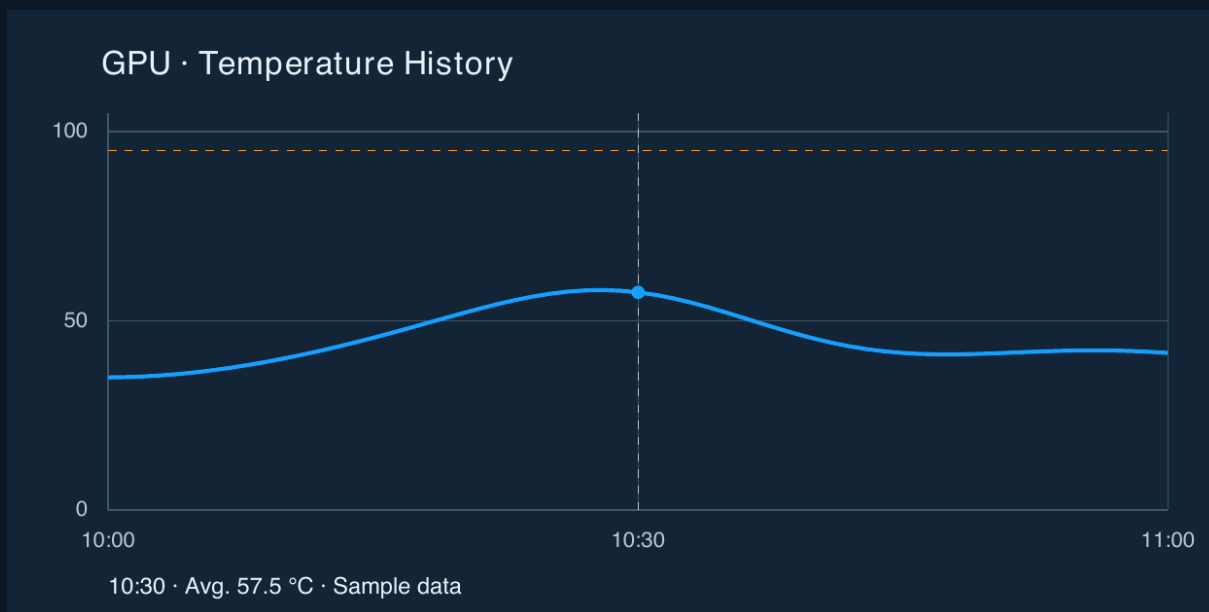
Right-click

The strip expands Window Size with Standard and Compact directly below it.



Temperature history & alerts

Local minute averages and restrained macOS notifications.



Temperature History

Choose 1, 3, 6, 12 or 24 hours. Click or drag in the chart to mark the nearest recorded point and show its time and minute average. Changing the range clears the selection. Click the card outside the chart to close history. The dashed line shows the warning threshold.

Off

CPU >

GPU >

Internal SSD >

External SSD >

85 °C

90 °C

✓ 95 °C

100 °C

Copy Current Readings

Export CSV...

Export

Copy text or save a local CSV with history and the current snapshot.

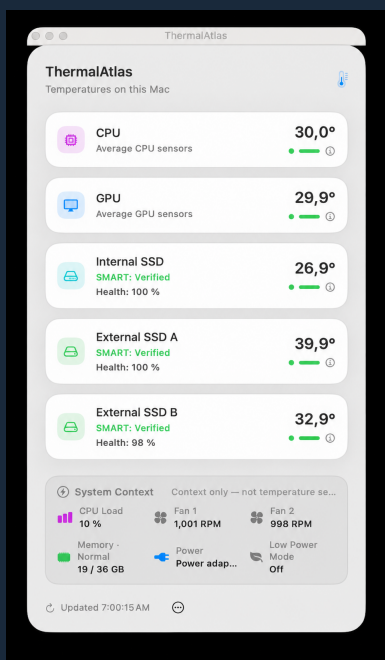
Themes

Four appearances, the same sensor data.

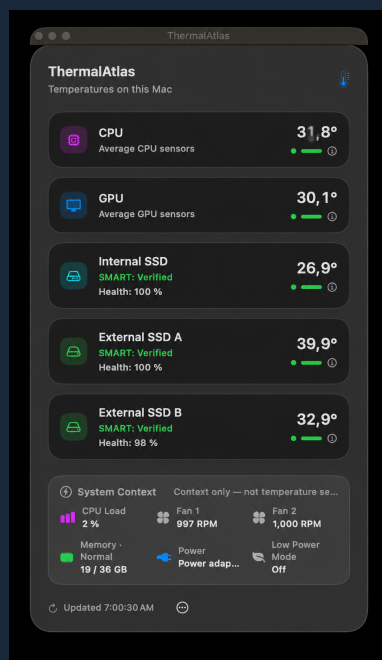
Adaptive: neutral macOS surfaces in light and dark mode. Drive names anonymized.

Adaptive

Light



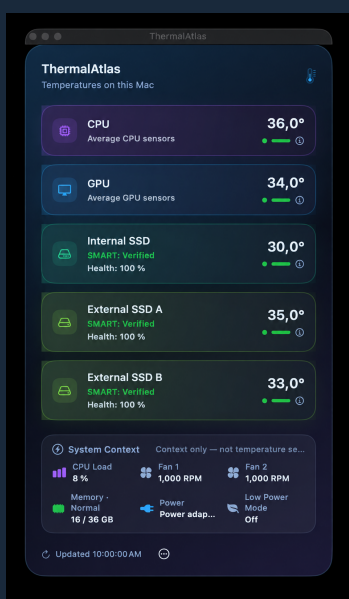
Dark



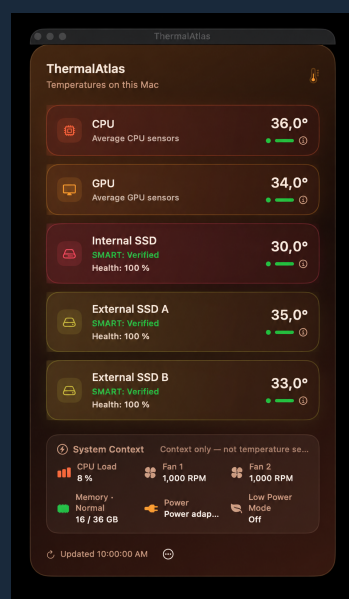
Liquid Glass



Aurora



Ember



Local & privacy-friendly

Read-only sensor checks without accounts, telemetry or cloud.

Local sensor data

No accounts, telemetry, analytics services or cloud synchronization. Temperature and fan history stay local for at most 24 hours.

Stored choices

Theme, Scan Refresh, language, visible sensor groups, menu bar mode, window size, Mini Display, Always on Top, warning thresholds and minute averages stay local. So do update intervals, check timestamps and already reported release tags.

Safe operation

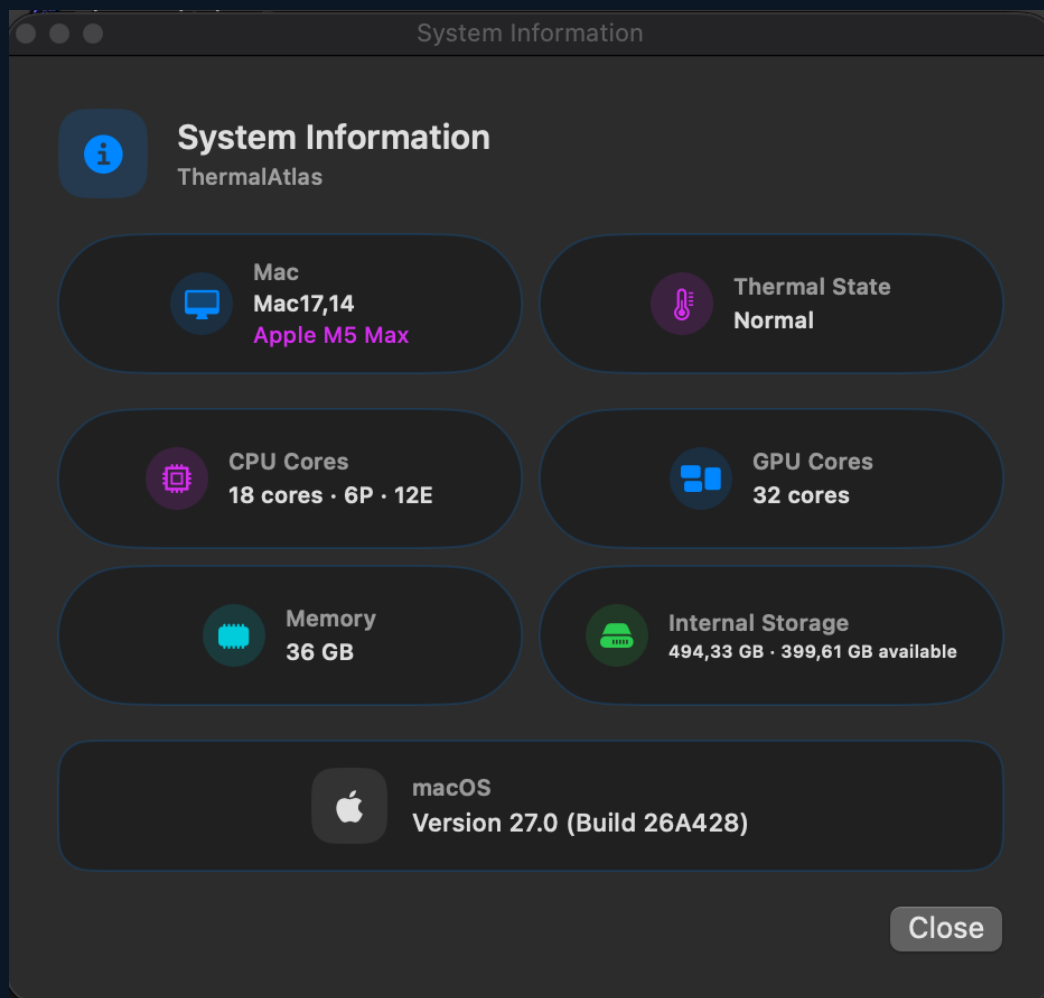
ThermalAtlas reads temperatures, drive information and system context. It changes no fan, power or other system settings.

GitHub update checks

Optional update checks contact GitHub over HTTPS. GitHub sees the IP address but receives no sensor or device data or installed version. Automatic checks are off by default (page 13). The README, privacy report and security review are in the official repository.

This Mac at a glance

The details stay local and are read only when opened.



Thermal State

macOS reports Normal, Elevated, High or Critical. This system assessment is not a temperature in degrees. Details are read when the window opens; reopen it for the current state.

Header thermometer

It opens the Mac model, chip, CPU/GPU cores, memory, internal storage and macOS version.

Private

No serial numbers, UUIDs or other hardware identifiers.

Open safely

Approve only the official app.

Gatekeeper

Public builds are ad-hoc signed and not notarized. macOS can therefore block the first launch.

How to open ThermalAtlas

1. Open ThermalAtlas.app normally once. macOS blocks the launch. 2. Open System Settings > Privacy & Security. 3. Scroll to Security and choose Open Anyway for ThermalAtlas. 4. Confirm the warning with Open and authenticate if macOS asks you to.

Only this app

Open Anyway is shown only for a limited time after the blocked launch attempt. This creates an exception only for ThermalAtlas and does not disable Gatekeeper system-wide. Use it only for an app obtained from the official ThermalAtlas GitHub release.

Settings & export

Choose these options in the ellipsis menu at the bottom of the main window.

Scan Refresh / Visible Temperatures

Scan Refresh selects 1, 2, 3 or 4 seconds for CPU and GPU; the default is 2 seconds. SSD temperatures are read every minute and System Context about every 0.5 seconds. Visible Temperatures switches CPU, GPU, Internal SSD or all External SSDs for the window, menu bar and mini strip. At least one group remains selected.

Menu Bar Display / Always on Top

All Values shows the selected available temperatures. Symbol Only leaves just the thermometer in the menu bar. Always on Top keeps the main window above normal app windows and adds full-screen support to the mini strip (page 5). Choose it again to turn it off. These choices are stored locally.

Export

Copy Current Readings copies current temperatures as text. Copy Diagnostic Report copies the Mac model, macOS version, chip and sensor status. Export CSV opens a save dialog for up to 24 hours of minute averages and the current snapshot. CSV includes time, sensor, source, temperature and value status plus available SMART data. Hotspots are not exported. No file is created without your choice.

Language / Start at Login

Language switches between English and Deutsch. The choice is stored; drive names stay unchanged. Start at Login enables app launch after signing in to macOS. Choose it again to disable it. Power and performance settings are unaffected.

Details & alerts

Temperature, history and system assessments serve different purposes.

Info symbol / Hotspot

The info symbol opens the source, last valid value and time. CPU and GPU also show the chip, average, highest readable sensor value (Hotspot) and valid sensor count. SSDs show the drive ID and available reading details. Cards, menu bar, mini strip and history show the average. A short GPU failure can retain a marked real value for at most 15 seconds, then shows Not available.

Temperature Alerts

CPU/GPU: 85, 90, 95 or 100 °C (default 95); SSDs: 60, 65, 70 or 75 °C (default 70). CPU/GPU use the Hotspot when available, otherwise the average. Notifications require at least one minute at or above the threshold; a new episode requires cooling. The menu bar frame turns yellow within ten degrees below the threshold and red at it, even with notifications disabled. History remains a minute average.

VoiceOver / appearance

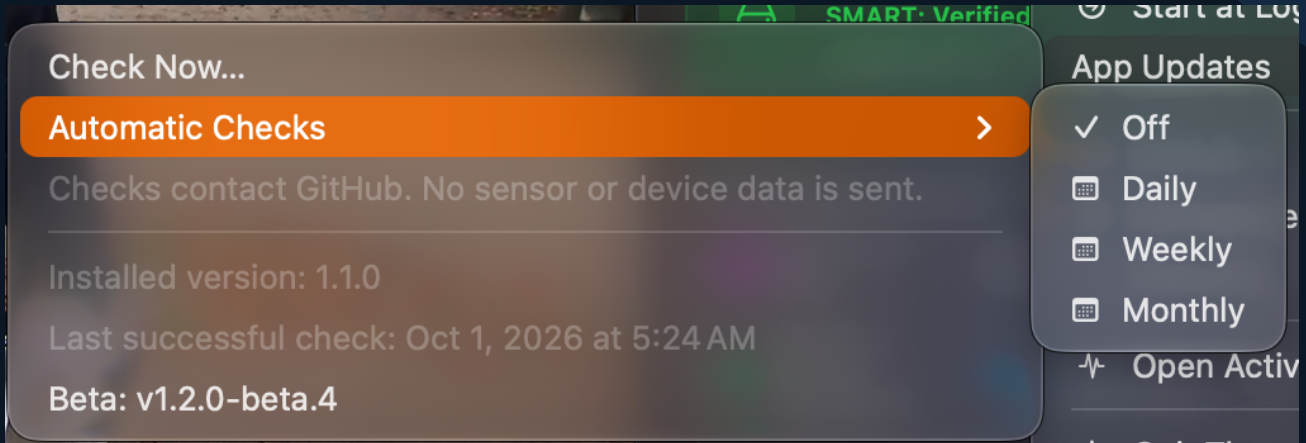
Temperature cards announce history state and controls through VoiceOver. Reduce Motion limits card and history-opening animations; Reduce Transparency makes glass surfaces opaque. In Liquid Glass on macOS 27 or later, the thermometer button uses interactive system glass. Memory status is Normal below 70%, Elevated below 85% and High from 85% usage; it is not a memory-pressure indicator.

Windows, links & quit

Drag the title bar or background to move the window. Closing hides the main window; collection continues. The menu bar item opens it again. GitHub, Homepage and Manuals open browser links. Open Activity Monitor opens Activity Monitor. Quit ThermalAtlas stops the app and collection.

Check Final and Beta versions

Available from Beta 1.2.0-beta.5.



English menu; version, timestamp and Beta tag are values from this capture.

Check Now

Open App Updates below Start at Login. Check Now checks immediately, even with Off selected. The result window lists newer versions or reports none available. A failed check does not confirm that the app is up to date.

Automatic Checks

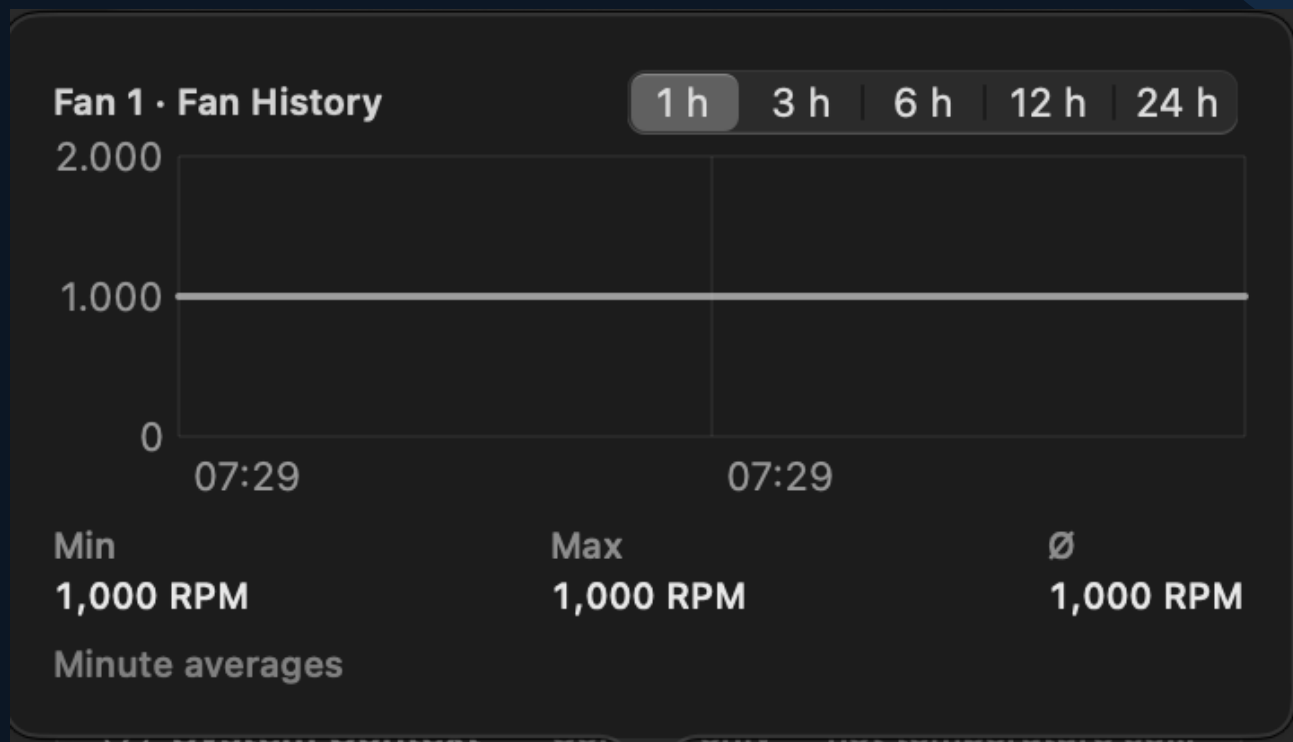
Off is the default. Daily checks after one calendar day, Weekly after seven days and Monthly after one calendar month from the last successful check. The app must be running; its main window and mini strip may be closed. Overdue checks are caught up. After a failure, an automatic retry waits at least one hour. The choice is stored locally.

Version, time and results

Installed version identifies the running app. Last successful check shows the last successful GitHub check. Final and Beta open the highest newer release in each channel. A Final is newer than a Beta with the same version number. New finds open a notice window; each release is reported automatically once. Check Now can show it again. You choose download and installation. Checks send no sensor or device data and use no stored cookies or credentials.

Fan speeds over time

Available from Beta 1.2.0-beta.6.



English capture: Fan 1, 1 h selected, figures rounded to 1,000 RPM.

Opening, range and axes

Open the main window from the menu bar; in Mini, choose Standard/Compact first. In System Context, click Fan or Fan 1/2 with its RPM value. Each fan opens its own history. 1/3/6/12/24 h limit the lookback in both fan and temperature history. The horizontal axis shows time; the vertical axis shows RPM. The curve shows minute averages. Both labels read 07:29 because this short interval is labelled without seconds.

Min / Max / average

Lowest, highest and mean minute average in the selected period; each recorded minute has equal weight. These are not instantaneous RPM peaks. All figures here round to 1,000 RPM. Click or drag for a point's time and value. Changing range clears selection; click outside to close. Storage is local for at most 24 hours. Missing values leave gaps; real 0 RPM remains valid. No fan control.

Reading age appears in Sensor Details; retained GPU values also show it directly on the card.

Keyboard & controls

Introduced in Beta 1.2.0-beta.7.

Select chart points

Click or drag in a temperature or fan chart to select a reading. Use the left/right arrow keys or Previous minute / Next minute buttons to move between points; Escape clears the selection. Time labels follow the app language. Isolated readings remain visible, including genuine 0 RPM.

Cards & Mini Display

Temperature cards are native buttons; VoiceOver announces their reading and history state. Return, Space and VoiceOver's press action open Mini Display's size controls.

System Context

Info explains CPU load, fans, memory and power; temperatures are in the cards above. Tiles reflow in Standard and Compact.

CSV save errors

If ThermalAtlas cannot write the CSV, the alert includes the macOS error description. Try Again reopens the save dialog; Close ends the export attempt.

Alerts, motion & Settings

The 60-second timer restarts after a sensor disappears and returns or its threshold changes. Reduce Motion disables animations as cards appear, history opens and the window resizes. macOS Settings offers Open ThermalAtlas for the main window.